

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Risk governance and controls professional with ~7 years of experience, targeting RBC's Director, Operational Risk Governance (Global Security) role. Model governance committee member at Moody's Analytics holding delegated sign-off on analytics delivered to institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement. Contributes to control framework documentation, benchmarking, and escalation standards within a formal governance framework; coordinates cross-functional regulatory transformation programs and stakeholder management across risk, product, and client functions; quantifies exposures through scenario and stress analysis. CFA charterholder with dual MSc degrees and applied familiarity with OSFI E-23 model-risk expectations and Basel Committee-aligned IRRBB standards.

CORE SKILLS

Risk Governance & Control Framework Contribution (Documentation, Benchmarking, Methodology Review) • Independent Review, Challenge & Delegated Sign-Off • Model Risk Management (OSFI E-23 / SR 11-7 aligned) • Risk Assessment, Quantification & Prioritization • Scenario Analysis & Stress Testing • Control Documentation & Audit Readiness • Escalation, Remediation & Stakeholder Management • Regulatory Readiness (OSFI-aligned; IFRS 17 / IFRS 9 transformation) • Cross-Functional Program Delivery (Influence Without Direct Authority) • Executive & Committee-Level Reporting • Process Automation & AI-Assisted Anomaly Detection • Python, SQL & Advanced Excel

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director, Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Governance Execution & Independent Oversight

- Serves on the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for analytics delivered to institutional clients.
- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions before production release.
- Operates within a formal model governance framework, validating assumptions and economic defensibility against documentation standards consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 model risk expectations.

Risk Assessment, Scenario Analysis & Monitoring

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, giving senior stakeholders forward-looking exposure visibility.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed liquidity and balance-sheet exposure analytics (T+1 through multi-year), enabling funding-related risk exposures to be quantified, monitored, and escalated across horizons.
- Oversees quantification of interest-rate and balance-sheet exposures under parallel and non-parallel shock scenarios, an approach analogous to Basel Committee IRRBB supervisory frameworks.

Process Control Design, Automation & Audit Readiness

- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable Python pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and auditability controls, shadow-running two cycles before cutover to satisfy governance audit requirements.
- Built agentic AI workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection, reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Escalation, Remediation & Stakeholder Communication

- Acts as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, holding release of outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and coordinating remediation with product owners and clients' Heads of Risk.

- Prepares analytical summaries for senior stakeholders covering exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities, translating quantitative output into committee-ready narratives as part of ongoing stakeholder management with Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms, acting as technical liaison between client stakeholders and product owners.
- Contributed to the migration of all assigned client accounts from the legacy Calypso platform to PFaroe PM, validating model outputs post-deployment.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant, IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation programs for Canadian and international insurers, translating regulatory requirements into system implementation and financial reporting frameworks.
- Contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes for financial institutions, advising actuarial, IT, finance, and program-management functions on standards adoption.
- Coordinated actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and project-management teams on milestone delivery and implementation materials across enterprise-wide programs, without formal authority over those teams.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant, Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Quantified funding-ratio, duration-mismatch, and long-horizon balance-sheet risk exposures through ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators assessing risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed risk decomposition and attribution (contribution-to-risk, risk budgeting) alongside VaR and CVaR optimization on Ortec's GLASS platform to prioritize exposures and test the robustness of recommendations.
- Designed stochastic risk-management frameworks tailored to specific client mandates.
- Presented study findings and risk recommendations on-site to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016